

STUDY BUDDY

How to Study and Feel Good While Doing It



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Become Your Own Best Study Buddy

Doing homework and studying is a skill that you learn over time. Sometimes its not easy. The good news is that you can begin to learn how to be your own best study buddy by using some tried-and-true tips to work smarter and do your best while feeling good about it. Its not always fun, but it is an important skill that will help you become a better lifelong learner.

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ASCA Standards:

A:A2.1 Apply time-management and task-management skills
 A:A2.4 Apply knowledge and learning styles to positively influence school performance
 A:B1.1 Demonstrate the motivation to achieve individual potential
 A:B1.3 Apply the study skills necessary for academic success at each level
 A:B1.4 Seek information and support from faculty, staff, family and peers
 A:B1.6 Use knowledge of learning styles to positively influence school performance



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What's Your Learning Style?

Everyone is unique and we all learn a little bit differently. Take [this quiz](#) to discover your learning style!

"Everyone is unique and we all learn a little bit differently."

Learning Style Reflection

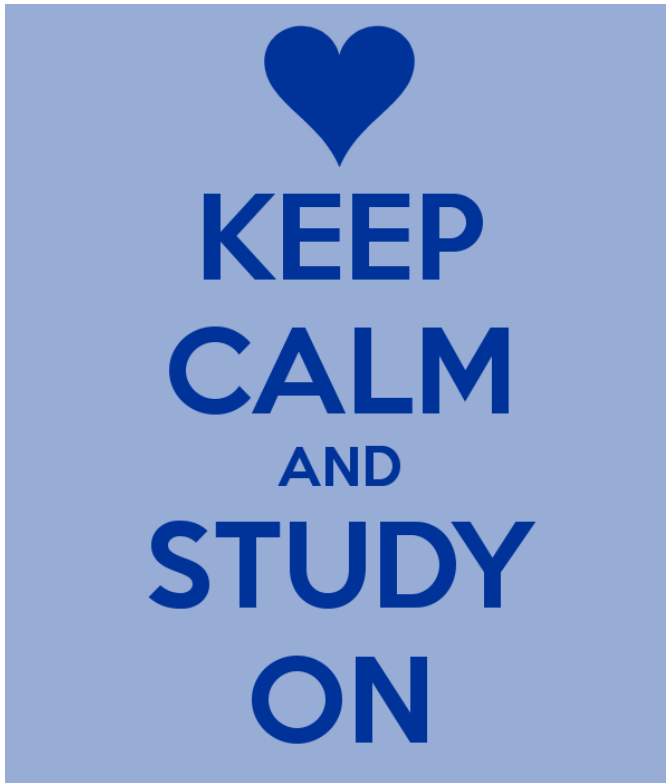
1. Which learning style did you think you were before the quiz? Circle one.

Visual Auditory Kinesthetic Read/Write Wasn't Sure

2. Which learning style did you score as from the quiz?

3. What is something new or interesting you *learned* about your learning style? Write your answer here.

3. How can you adjust your homework and study habits to match your learning style? If you are not sure, ask your teacher or school counselor. Write your answer here.



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Top 10 Study Tips

1. Write down your homework! Its easy and only takes a few minutes.
2. Schedule your homework/study time. Its helpful to do homework at the same time each day, if possible.
3. Silence your device(s) and remove any distractions.
4. Start right away! When you get home, take 15-20 minutes to eat a healthy snack and then get started.
5. Do the hardest assignment FIRST.
6. Review any notes before completing work.
7. Make flashcards! If you need help making flashcards, ask an adult.
8. Break it up. If you have a big project, break it up into parts and work on it for 10 or 15 minutes each day instead of doing it all in one day.
9. Call a friend if you need help.
10. Review for a few minutes on the weekend.

Quiz Time!

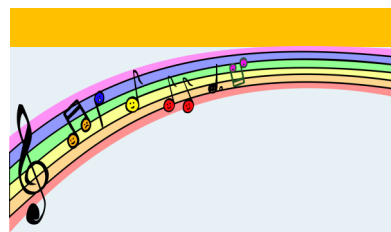
Which study habits do you need to improve? Take this quiz to find out! Then, answer the following questions:

1. According to the quiz, what's the number one study habit you need to improve?

2. What help might you need from your parents/guardians to improve this study habit?



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Should I Listen to Music While Studying?

Some research studies have found that listening to music, especially soft music without vocals, can improve your brain's performance while studying. However, other studies have shown that silence is best. What's the real answer? It depends. Most studies show that listening to any type of music *before* studying can improve your performance. When trying to decide whether you should listen to music while doing homework or studying, try doing your own experiment. Do homework or study for a few days with music and a few days without. Was there a difference in how you felt or how you did? Still not sure? That's okay. As you get older and have more practice studying in different environments, you will become more in tune with your preferences.

The Ultimate Study Space

It's true, doing homework is not always fun. But, you can personalize your study space to make it comfortable, colorful, and prepared with the necessary materials so you can feel good about your study space. The following guide can help create your ultimate study space. Is your study space:

1. Always available?
2. Free of interruptions/ distractions?
3. Prepared with the necessary materials (pencils, pens, paper, etc.)?
4. Large enough?
5. Do you have storage space for your materials/books?
6. Do you have a comfortable chair?
7. Is there enough light?
8. Is the temperature not too hot or too cold?
9. Do you have something colorful or inspirational nearby?
10. Is the noise level where you like it? (See "Should I Listen to Music While Studying?" on the left of this page.)

YOUR Brain Break

If you have been reading this straight through, it's time for a brain break. Take a minute to breathe deeply, stand up, and stretch. Notice how you feel. Breaks are SO important. When your brain has been working hard for a long time, **reward** yourself with a quick break so you can keep your mental stamina to finish what you need to do.

The neat thing about taking a brain break while you are doing homework or studying is that you can customize it to fit your preferences and personality.

Take a moment to think about how studying makes you feel. After working hard for a long time, do you need to **calm down** or **get moving**? Here are some ideas to get you thinking about what your brain break could be. Put a star next to the strategies you would like to try.

If you need to **CALM DOWN**:

- ⇒ Deep, slow breaths
- ⇒ Close your eyes and imagine your favorite place. What does it feel like to be there? What's your favorite part about it? Use your imagination to soothe your nervous or anxious feelings.
- ⇒ Stretch. Ask an adult to help you find an appropriate video online to follow along to if you are not sure how to stretch.

If you need to **GET MOVING**:

- ⇒ Dance to your favorite song
- ⇒ Run in place for 30 seconds or do 10 jumping jacks
- ⇒ Have a small, healthy snack to increase your energy

* **If none of these are for you, ask an adult if you can go outside for a few**

Snack Time

A healthy snack can give you the energy you need to feel better while doing homework or studying. Here is some healthy snack inspiration to share with your parent/guardian:

- ◇ Smoothie—Try blending protein powder, leafy greens, and your favorite frozen fruits.
- ◇ Yogurt—Add some fun toppings like blueberries, granola, or flax seeds.
- ◇ Quesadillas—You can mix anything you like into a quesadilla! Experiment with different types of cheese, veggies, and meats and/or beans.
- ◇ Homemade Sweet Potato Chips— Sweet potatoes are a rich source of vitamins and can be baked into a crispy, fun snack. Be sure to have an adult help you anytime you bake or use heat in the kitchen.
- ◇ Eggs—Add eggs to multigrain toast/wrap or pita bread with a bit of cheese and your favorite vegetable for a protein-packed snack.
- ◇ Hummus— Serve with cut-up vegetables or multigrain crackers.
- ◇ Trail Mix—You can buy this premade or experiment with creating your



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In Summary

You have read about your learning style, top study tips, creating your ultimate study space, and some healthy snack ideas. What changes do you need to make? Write 3 changes you want to make right away:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

How do you feel about making these changes? Circle the words that represent how you feel.

Inspired Motivated Happy Unsure Worried
Nervous Anxious Frustrated Brave
Excited Hopeful
Other _____

How can your teacher help you improve your study habits?

How can your school counselor help you improve your study habits?

How can your parent/guardian help you improve your study habits?

CONGRATULATIONS on learning about study habits and being open to new ideas to help you improve your performance.

____ I went over this information with my school counselor.

____ I shared this information with my parent/guardian.

KEEP THIS WITH YOU. Find a safe spot in your agenda or homework folder so you can look at it as needed.

PARENTS: Please sign and return acknowledgement form to the school counselor.